

SETTING UP ZOHU CREATOR & EXPLORING ARCHITECTURE

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1. Aim

To set up and explore the Zoho Creator platform by creating a **Corporate Asset Maintenance** application, designing forms, generating reports and dashboards, and understanding the **Develop**, **Deploy**, and **Manage** sections of the platform.

2. Setting up Zoho Creator

A Zoho Creator application named **Corporate Asset Maintenance** was created to manage company assets and their maintenance activities.

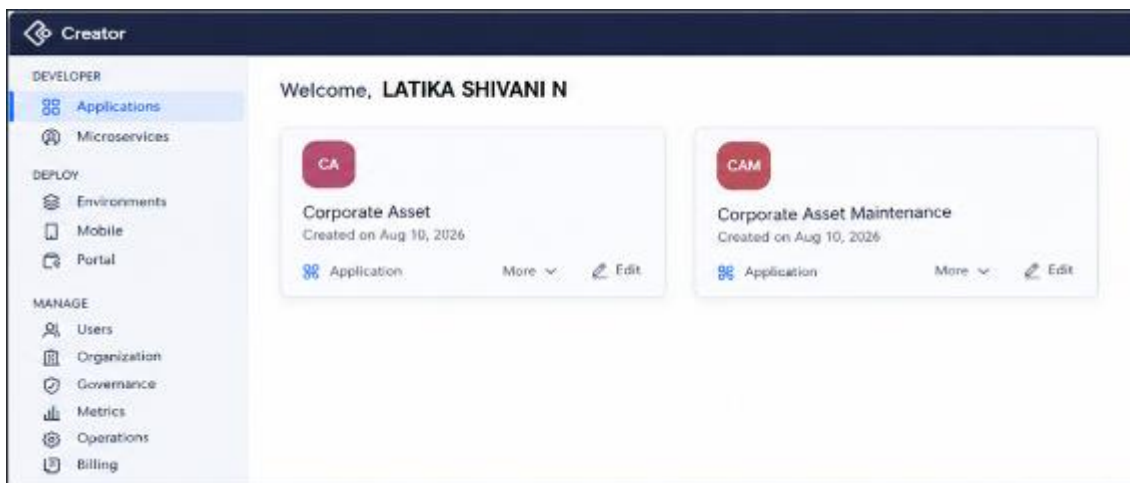


Figure 2.1: Zoho Creator Welcome Screen showing created application "Corporate Asset Maintenance"

The application contains the following forms:

- **Department:** Stores department details such as Department ID, Department Name, Department Head, and Location.
- **Asset Details:** Maintains information about company assets such as Asset ID, Asset Name, Category, Purchase Cost, and Asset Status.
- **Technician:** Stores technician details such as Technician ID, Name, Specialization, Experience, and Availability.
- **Maintenance Request:** Records maintenance requests raised for company assets.
- **Maintenance Approvals:** Manages approval of maintenance requests based on the estimated cost.
- **Repair Progress:** Tracks the repair activities performed by technicians.

A. Creating Form

A Form in Zoho Creator is used to collect and store information from users. In the Corporate Asset Maintenance application, forms are created for departments, assets, technicians, maintenance requests, approvals, and repair progress.

For example, the **Technician Form** collects information such as Technician Name, Phone Number, Email, Specialization, Experience, and Availability Status.

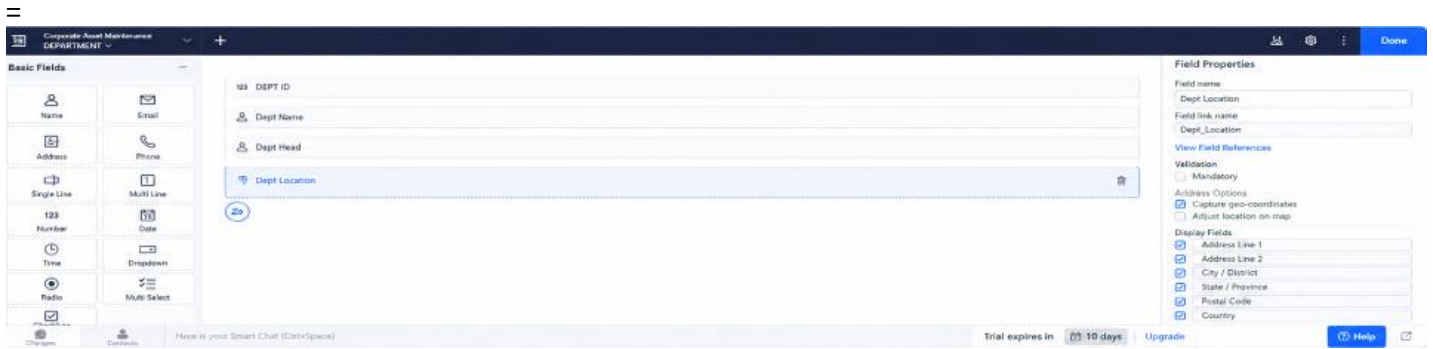


Figure 2.2: Zoho Creator Form Builder creating the 'DEPARTMENT' form fields

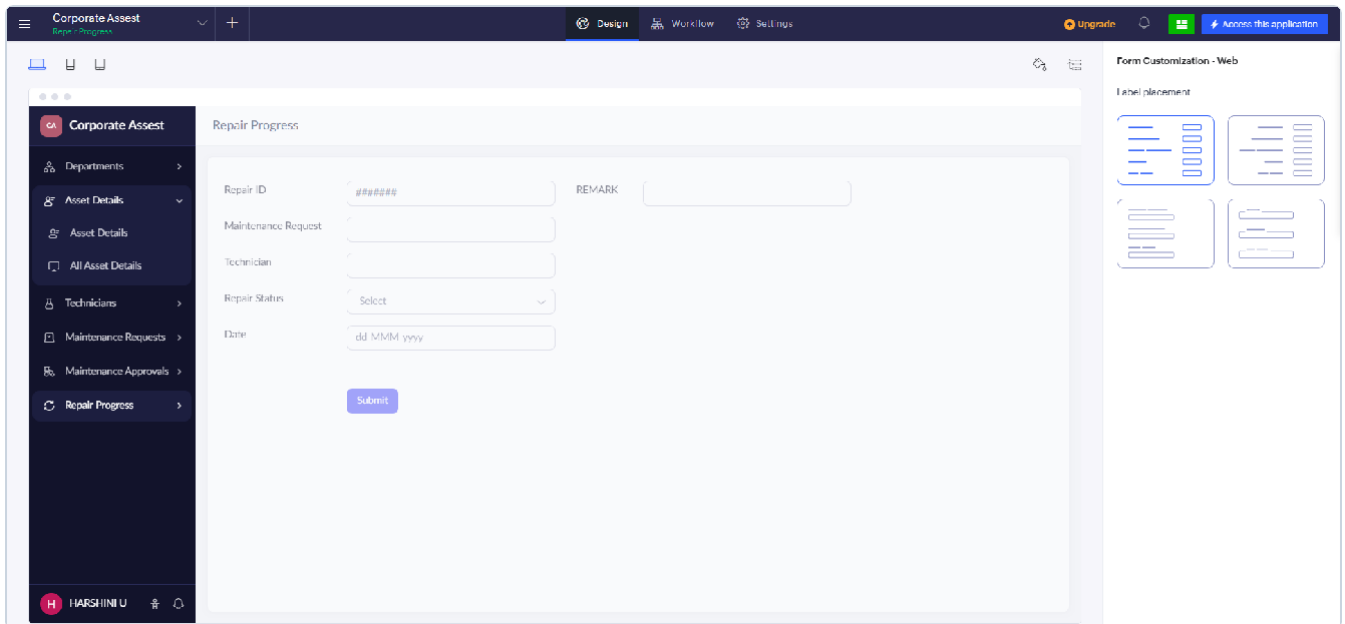


Figure 2.3: Form design and customization interface for 'Repair Progress'

Figure 2.4: Department Form user interface for submitting data

Explanation:

The form provides fields for entering technician and department information. When the user submits the form, the entered data is stored in the application's database and can be viewed through reports.

B. Creating Report

A Report is used to display and organize the data submitted through a form.

For example, the **Asset Details Report** displays asset information such as Asset ID, Asset Name, Asset Category, Serial Number, Purchase Date, Warranty Expiry Date, and Purchase Cost.

	DEPT ID	Dept Head	DEPT Name	Dept Location
	2	sdf	ecw	chennai
	1	abc	cse	chennai

Figure 2.5: Report view displaying submitted records ("All Departments")

Explanation:

The report automatically displays the records entered through the Asset Details and Department forms. It helps users view, search, sort, and manage asset information efficiently.

C. Creating Dashboard

A Dashboard provides a visual summary of important information using panels and charts.

The Corporate Asset Dashboard displays key information such as:

- Total Assets
- Total Maintenance Requests
- Pending Approvals
- Completed Repairs

The screenshot shows the 'Corporate Asset' dashboard interface. On the left is a dark sidebar with navigation links: Departments, Asset Details, Technicians, Maintenance Requests, Maintenance Approvals, Repair Progress, and 'Corporate asset dashboard' (highlighted in blue). The main content area displays two identical panels, each titled 'All Departments'. Each panel contains a table with the following data:

DEPT ID	Dept Head	DEPT Name	Dept Location
2	sul	enr	shenai
1	abc	cse	chenai

Below each table, it says 'Showing 2 of 2'. The top of the dashboard has a header with 'Corporate Asset', user icons, and a 'Trial expires in 10 days' message. The bottom left shows a user profile for 'HARSHINI U'.

Figure 2.6: Corporate Asset Dashboard displaying visual reports and metrics

Explanation:

The dashboard provides management with a quick overview of asset and maintenance activities. The values are automatically updated based on the data stored in the application.

3. Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

A. Develop

- The Develop section is used to create and customize applications in Zoho Creator.
- It allows developers to create forms, reports, pages, workflows, and dashboards.
- It also supports Deluge scripting for implementing application logic and automation.

B. Deploy

- The Deploy section is used to make the developed application available to end users.
- Applications can be accessed through web and mobile interfaces.
- User access and permissions can be configured based on different roles.

C. Manage

- The Manage section is used to maintain and administer the application.

- It provides options to manage users, permissions, data, settings, and integrations.
- Administrators can monitor the application and modify its configuration when required.

Result:

Thus, the Corporate Asset Maintenance application was successfully created and explored using Zoho Creator. Forms, reports, and a dashboard were created to manage asset maintenance activities, and the Develop, Deploy, and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator platform were studied.